



## INFORMATION AND INSTRUCTIONS TO HELP YOU COMPLETE THE AUTHORIZATION TO DISCLOSE PERSONAL INFORMATION TO A THIRD PARTY- EDUCATION BENEFITS

### GENERAL INFORMATION

At VA, we recognize and respect the importance of privacy. Personal information that we collect is kept confidential to the extent provided by law. In accordance with the Privacy Act and applicable confidentiality statutes, VA will only disclose the information in its custody or control in the following circumstances: where the individual identifies the particular information and consents to its use; where disclosure of the information is required by law; or where the disclosure is otherwise legally permitted, including release for a purpose compatible with the purpose for which it was collected.

By law, VA must have your written permission (an "authorization") to use or give out your claim or benefit information for any purpose that is not permitted by all applicable legal authorities. You may revoke your written permission at any time, except if VA has already acted based on your permission.

**NOTE:** You should make a copy of your signed authorization for your records before sending it to VA. You can only have **one** VA Form 22-10278, *Authorization to Disclose Personal Information to a Third Party - Education Benefits*, on file with VA at a time.

### WHAT IF I CHANGE MY MIND?

If you change your mind and do not want VA to give out your personal benefit or claim information, you may notify us in writing using [QuickSubmit on AccessVA](#), by mail, or by telephone at 1-888-442-4551. Upon notification from you VA will no longer give out benefit or claim information (except for the information VA has already given out based on your permission).

| QUESTIONS | SPECIFIC INSTRUCTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1-7       | In this section, give us your identifying information to include name, social security number, VA file number, date of birth, mailing address, telephone number and e-mail address.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 8-11      | <p>In Item 8 VA will give your personal benefit or claim information to the person or organization you enter in this box. You may select only <b>one person</b> or <b>one organization</b>. If you designate an organization, you must also identify one or more individuals in that organization to whom VA may disclose your benefit or claim information. This form <b>cannot</b> be used to disclose federal tax information, provide copies of letters and notifications or allow any type of changes to the claimant's VA record, such as address, email, or direct deposit.</p> <p>Item 11 tells VA the duration of your consent. If you do not want your authorization to be effective indefinitely, tell us when to stop releasing your personal benefit or claim information to your authorized third party in Item 11. Check the box that applies and fill in dates, if applicable.</p> |
| 12        | Select the security question you would like us to ask your designated third party and provide the answer, or create a pin, password, or security question and answer of your own. This pin, password, or question will be asked each time your designated third party contacts the VA.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## WHERE DO I SEND MY AUTHORIZATION?

You can submit your signed authorization using [QuickSubmit on AccessVA](#) or mail the signed authorization to the Regional Processing Office for your region listed in the chart below.

| MAIL TO                                                                                      |                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b><u>EASTERN REGION</u></b><br><br>VA Regional Office<br>P.O. Box 4614<br>Buffalo, NY 14240 | <b><u>WESTERN REGION</u></b><br><br>VA Regional Office<br>P.O. Box 888<br>Muskogee, OK 74402 |

|                                                                                  |    |              |    |                 |    |    |                   |    |    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|--------------|----|-----------------|----|----|-------------------|----|----|
| Eastern Region:<br>VA Regional Office<br>P.O. Box 4616<br>Buffalo, NY 14240-4616 |    |              |    |                 |    |    |                   |    |    |
| SERVES THE FOLLOWING STATES                                                      |    |              |    |                 |    |    |                   |    |    |
| CO                                                                               | CT | DC           | DE | IA              | IL | IN | KS                | KY | MA |
| MD                                                                               | ME | MI           | MN | MO              | MT | NC | ND                | NE | NH |
| NJ                                                                               | NY | OH           | PA | RI              | SD | TN | VA                | VT | WI |
| WV                                                                               | WY | APO / FPO AA |    | FOREIGN SCHOOLS |    |    | US VIRGIN ISLANDS |    |    |

|                                                                                   |    |      |    |             |    |                |    |                 |    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|------|----|-------------|----|----------------|----|-----------------|----|
| Western Region:<br>VA Regional Office<br>P.O. Box 8888<br>Muskogee, OK 74402-8888 |    |      |    |             |    |                |    |                 |    |
| SERVES THE FOLLOWING STATES                                                       |    |      |    |             |    |                |    |                 |    |
| AK                                                                                | AL | AR   | AZ | CA          | FL | GA             | HI | ID              | LA |
| MS                                                                                | NM | NV   | OK | OR          | PR | SC             | TX | UT              | WA |
| APO / FPO AP                                                                      |    | GUAM |    | PHILIPPINES |    | AMERICAN SAMOA |    | MARIANA ISLANDS |    |



U.S. Department  
of Veterans Affairs

## AUTHORIZATION TO DISCLOSE PERSONAL INFORMATION TO A THIRD PARTY- EDUCATION BENEFITS

**INSTRUCTIONS:** Use this form if you want to give the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) permission to release your personal benefit or claim information to a third party. This form **may not be executed** by any claimant recognized as incompetent for VA purposes, nor can VA **accept** this form from any claimant recognized as incompetent for VA purposes.

### SECTION I - CLAIMANT'S IDENTIFYING INFORMATION

**NOTE:** You may **either** complete the form online or by hand. If completed by hand print the information requested in ink, neatly, and legibly to expedite processing the form.

1. CLAIMANT'S NAME (*First, Middle Initial, Last*)

2. CLAIMANT'S SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER

3. VA FILE NUMBER (*If known*)

4. CLAIMANT'S DATE OF BIRTH (*MM/DD/YYYY*)

5. MAILING ADDRESS OF CLAIMANT (*Number and Street or rural route, P.O. Box, City, State, ZIP Code and Country*)

6. TELEPHONE NUMBER (*Include Area Code*)

Enter International Phone Number (*If applicable*)

7. EMAIL ADDRESS (*Optional*)

☐ I agree to receive electronic correspondence from VA in regards to my authorization.

### SECTION II - CONTACT'S INFORMATION

8. VA IS AUTHORIZED TO DISCLOSE THE INFORMATION SPECIFIED BELOW TO ONE PERSON **OR** ONE ORGANIZATION LISTED BELOW.  
PROVIDE THE NAME AND ADDRESS OF THE PERSON YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO RECEIVE INFORMATION FROM VA IN ITEMS 8A AND 8B **OR** PROVIDE  
THE NAME AND ADDRESS OF THE ORGANIZATION YOU HAVE CHOSEN AND THE NAME OF THE ORGANIZATION'S REPRESENTATIVE IN ITEMS 8C AND 8D.

A. NAME OF PERSON (*First, Middle Initial, Last Name*)

B. ADDRESS OF PERSON

**NOTE:** An organization may have more than one representative. Include the first and last name of any additional representatives.

C. NAME OF ORGANIZATION (*Include name of representative(s)*)

CLAIMANT'S SSN

D. ADDRESS OF ORGANIZATION

  

9. I, THE CLAIMANT AUTHORIZE VA TO SPEAK WITH THE PERSON **OR** ORGANIZATION LISTED IN ITEM 8A OR 8C FOR THE PURPOSE OF PROVIDING THE FOLLOWING INFORMATION PERTAINING TO MY VA RECORD (Check only one box to tell VA if only specific benefit or claim information can be disclosed, or if all applicable benefit information can be disclosed)

☐ LIMITED INFORMATION (Go to Item 10)

☐ ALL INFORMATION BELOW (Skip to Item 11)

10. IF YOU SELECTED "LIMITED INFORMATION", SELECT ALL THAT APPLY

☐ Status of pending claim or appeal

☐ Amount of money owed VA

☐ Other (Specify below) (Note: Third parties cannot initiate any changes to your record)

☐ Current benefit and rate

☐ Change of address or direct deposit  
(Only allowed if claimant is a minor)

☐ Payment history

11. THE TIMEFRAME FOR THE RELEASE OF INFORMATION INDICATED ABOVE WILL BE:

☐ Ongoing until written notice is given to VA to terminate

☐ From the date of signing below until

(Specify date - MM/DD/YYYY)

12. SPECIFY THE PIN, PASSWORD, OR SECURITY QUESTION YOU WANT USED WHEN VERIFYING THE IDENTITY OF YOUR DESIGNATED THIRD PARTY. CHECK ONLY **ONE** BOX IN ITEM 12A AND PROVIDE THE ANSWER IN ITEM 12B.

A. SECURITY QUESTION

B. ANSWER

SECTION III - DECLARATION OF INTENT

I CERTIFY THAT the statements on this form are true and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief.

13. CLAIMANT'S SIGNATURE (REQUIRED)

14. DATE SIGNED (MM/DD/YYYY)

**PRIVACY ACT INFORMATION:** VA will not disclose information collected on this form to any source other than what has been authorized under the Privacy Act of 1974 or title 38, Code of Federal Regulations 1.576 for routine uses (i.e., civil or criminal law enforcement, congressional communications, epidemiological or research studies, the collection of money owed to the United States, litigation in which the United States is a party or has an interest, the administration of VA programs and delivery of VA benefits, verification of identity and status, and personnel administration as identified in the VA system of records, 58VA21/22/28 Compensation, Pension, Education, and Veteran Readiness and Employment Records - VA, published in the Federal Register. Your obligation to respond is voluntary. VA uses your SSN to identify your claim file. Providing your SSN will help ensure that your records are properly associated with your claim file. Giving us your SSN account information is voluntary. Refusal to provide your SSN by itself will not result in the denial of benefits. The VA will not deny an individual benefits for refusing to provide his or her SSN unless the disclosure of the SSN is required by Federal Statute of law in effect prior to January 1, 1975, and still in effect.

**RESPONDENT BURDEN:** An agency may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, a collection of information unless it displays a currently valid OMB control number. The OMB control number for this project is 2900-0914, and it expires 12/31/2028. Public reporting burden for this collection of information is estimated to average 5 minutes per respondent, per year, including the time for reviewing instructions, searching existing data sources, gathering and maintaining the data needed, and completing and reviewing the collection of information. Send comments regarding this burden estimate and any other aspect of this collection of information, including suggestions for reducing the burden, to VA Reports Clearance Officer at [vapra@va.gov](mailto:vapra@va.gov). Please refer to OMB Control No. 2900-0914 in any correspondence. Do not send your completed VA Form 22-10278 to this email address.